Great but Forgotten Rock Bands

Index.HTML/HomePage

Introduction

Rock music is important to people , because it allows them to escape this crazy world. It allows them not to run away from the problems that are there, but to face up to them , but at the same time sort of DANCE ALL OVER THEM. That's what rock and roll is about.

Pete Townshend(Co-founder of The Who)

Hello, I'm Nino Loladze, and rock music has been a staple of my life since childhood. Growing up, I spent countless hours with my dad, exploring every corner of the rock genre—from classic legends to hidden gems that never got the recognition they deserved. This site is dedicated to those bands: the ones that shaped rock history but have somehow faded from the spotlight. I believe great music shouldn't be forgotten, and this is a space to rediscover and celebrate the bands that deserve more attention. Whether you're here to reminisce about an old favorite or discover something new, I also invite you to share your own thoughts and recommendations. Let's bring these great bands back into the conversation together!

Please be aware that my list is strongly subjective and your input is also valuable and could be added to the list!

Here are the pages of website:

1. Homepage - Brief Overview of Rock History
2. Forgotten Bands
3. Form

Brief Overview of Rock History

Rock music emerged in the 1950s, born from the fusion of blues, country, and rhythm & blues. Early pioneers like Chuck Berry, Little Richard, and Elvis Presley set the foundation, injecting raw energy and rebellious spirit into popular music. As the genre evolved in the 1960s, bands like The Beatles, The Rolling Stones, and The Who expanded its boundaries, blending rock with folk, psychedelia, and blues.

The 1970s saw the rise of progressive rock, heavy metal, and experimental sounds. Bands like Led Zeppelin and Deep Purple pushed rock's heaviness, while Pink Floyd, Yes, and King Crimson introduced complex compositions and concept albums. Meanwhile, outside of the mainstream, bands like Can, Magma, and Embryo crafted entirely new sonic landscapes, experimenting with jazz, world music, and avant-garde structures.

In the late '70s, punk and new wave rebelled against rock's excess, bringing raw simplicity through The Ramones and The Clash, while art-rock and post-punk bands like Talking Heads and Joy Division took rock in new directions. The 1980s and '90s saw rock splinter into even more subgenres—alternative rock, grunge, and metal flourished, with bands like Nirvana, Radiohead, and Metallica reshaping the landscape.

Yet, for every band that made history, countless others remained in the shadows—innovative, groundbreaking, yet never receiving mainstream recognition. The bands featured on this site—Can, Magma, Embryo, Focus, Thunder Statue, and many more—were visionaries who pushed rock's boundaries but never quite reached the level of fame they deserved. Their music

remains timeless, proving that true artistry doesn't always need mainstream approval to leave an impact.

Here is also a great video by Ithaca Studio explaining the main history of rock music in 15 minutes.

Embedded video of Rock History(History.mp4)

Author: Nino Loladze (nloladze@aat.ge)

Forgotten Rock Bands

Birth Control (1966)

Birth Control is a German progressive and hard rock band formed in 1966. Their music depicts heavy sound, complex compositions, and satirical lyrics. Despite lineup changes over the decades, Birth Control continued to evolve, blending elements of psychedelic rock, jazz, and blues into their music. While they never reached mainstream international fame, their influence on European rock is undeniable, making them a great but often forgotten band. Their music paved the way for many of today's progressive and hard rock bands, and their albums still hold a special place in the hearts of dedicated fans. Birth Control was ahead of its time, and their legacy continues to inspire, but more commercially successful bands often overshadow them. That's

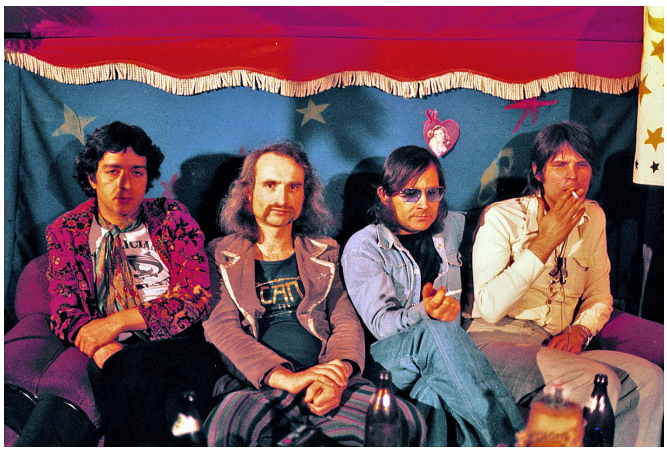
why they are both great and forgotten—lost in the shuffle of time, but deserving of a more prominent spot in the history of rock music.

I also love their unique album covers, which is a heavily underrated topic. Their album art often played with surrealism, abstract concepts, and sometimes humor, adding another layer of intrigue to their music. Unfortunately, album covers often take a backseat to the music itself in discussions of band legacies, but Birth Control's covers are an essential part of their identity, adding a visual element to their already dynamic sound. They remain an underrated topic, but when you dive into their discography, the artwork becomes an integral part of the experience, creating a deeper connection to their music and their message.

Here are few examples with one music, so you understand this aspect.

Embedded song(TheWorkIsDone.mp3)	Embedded song(FlyTrap.mp3)	Embedded song(Suicide.mp3)

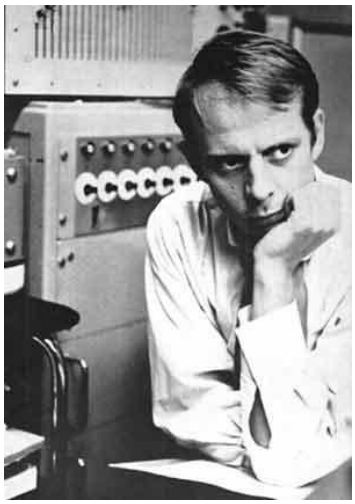
Can (1968)



Can is one of the most influential yet underrated bands in rock history. As key figures in the Krautrock movement, they redefined what rock music could be by blending avant-garde experimentation,

jazz-inspired improvisation, electronic textures, and hypnotic grooves. Their music pushed boundaries in ways that were far ahead of their time, laying the groundwork for numerous genres, including post-punk, ambient, electronic, and even hip-hop sampling.

Despite their profound influence, Can remains largely unknown to mainstream audiences, often overshadowed by more commercially successful rock bands. They lacked conventional hits, favoring long, hypnotic jams over radio-friendly singles. Their music, rooted in improvisation and inspired by avant-garde composer Karlheinz Stockhausen, was fluid, unpredictable, and hard to categorize. Their embrace of noise, electronic elements, and unconventional time signatures distanced them from commercial rock radio.



Emerging from West Germany in the late 1960s, Can was labeled as "Krautrock," a term that initially marginalized them. Unlike their blues-influenced contemporaries like Led Zeppelin and The Rolling Stones, Can operated outside traditional rock structures. They recorded in their own studio, Inner Space, and never chased mainstream success, staying true to their experimental vision.

Yet, they deserve far more recognition. Bassist Holger Czukay pioneered tape editing and sampling, influencing future electronic and hip-hop production. Drummer Jaki Liebezeit’s hypnotic, precision-driven "motorik" beat became a blueprint for post-punk and electronic music. Can constantly reinvented

themselves—*Monster Movie* (1969) was raw garage rock, *Tago Mago* (1971) delved into psychedelic madness, *Future Days* (1973) embraced ambient textures, and *Soon Over Babaluma* (1974) explored world music.

Their music still sounds futuristic today. Unlike many ‘70s bands that feel dated, Can’s innovative production and unconventional song structures make their albums as fresh as ever, proving they weren’t just ahead of their time—they were timeless.

My favorite songs of Can:

Mary, Mary So Contrary(Album: Monster Man)	Embedded audio(Mary,MarySoContrary.mp3)
Outside My Door(Album: Monster Man)	Embedded audio(OutsideMydoor.mp3)
Moonshake(Album: Future Days)	Embedded audio(Moonshake.mp3)
Dizzy Dizzy(Album: Soon over Babaluma)	Embedded song(DizzyDizzy.mp3)
Future Days(Album: Future Days)	Embedded audio(FutureDays.mp3)

Embryo (1969)

Despite their profound influence, Embryo remains one of the most overlooked and underappreciated bands of the progressive rock era. Unlike many of their German contemporaries, who leaned into hypnotic repetition and electronic textures, Embryo took a different path—one of constant evolution, cultural exploration, and boundary-pushing experimentation. They weren’t just a band; they were a musical collective, fusing jazz, rock, and world music in ways that still feel ahead of their time.

Formed in 1969 by multi-instrumentalist Christian Burchard, Embryo never fit neatly into any category. While they emerged from the "Krautrock" movement, their restless spirit took them far beyond it. They toured extensively across Africa, Asia, and the Middle East, collaborating with local musicians and incorporating new sounds into their music. While Pink Floyd and Genesis perfected their studio polish, Embryo thrived on raw, organic improvisation, making every performance unique. Their music was alive, ever-changing, and untamed.

They deserve far more recognition, not just for their musicianship but for their fearless approach to music. Burchard's percussion work was mesmerizing, blending jazz fluidity with tribal rhythms. Their albums defied convention—Rocksession (1973) was an electrifying jam-based masterpiece, We Keep On (1973) pulsed with hypnotic grooves and intricate solos, and Embryo's Reise (1979) was a revolutionary project that documented their journey across continents, blending traditional folk music with progressive rock, that is why this website provides this album with timestamped table. Embryo to me is truly timeless explorers, proving that music has no borders.

Embedded Audio(Reise.mp3)

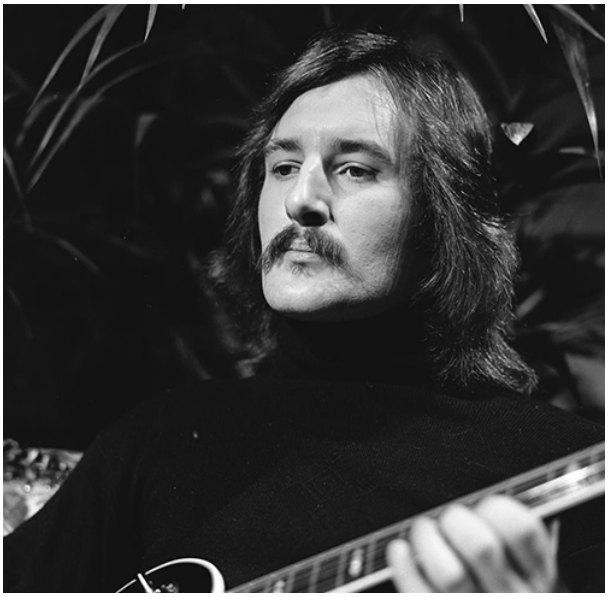
Strasse Nach Asien	00:00 - 12:17
Paki Funk	12:17 - 14:04
Lost Scooters	14:04 - 17:57
Anar, Anar	17:57 - 21:14
Es Ist, Wie's Ist	21:14 - 27:45
Kurdistan	27:45 - 32:24
Far East	32:24 - 38:59
Chan Delawar Khan	38:59 - 42:19
Farid	42:19 - 55:37
Cello, Cello	55:37 - 1:03:58
Rog De Quadamuna Achna	1:03:58 - 1:11:36
Hymalaya Radio	1:11:36 - 1:15:46
Maharaj (Variationen Für Sadhu, Saz Und Ziege)	1:15:46 - 1:19:29
Lassie, Lassie (Duju Di Je)	1:19:29 - 1:27:03

Focus(1969)

While many ‘70s rock bands leaned into blues-based structures or conceptual storytelling, Focus took a different approach—blending classical music, jazz improvisation, and rock virtuosity into something both sophisticated and wildly energetic. Their music was dynamic, unpredictable, and at times downright eccentric, yet their technical brilliance was undeniable.While many ‘70s rock bands leaned into blues-based structures or conceptual storytelling, Focus

took a different approach—blending classical music, jazz improvisation, and rock virtuosity into something both sophisticated and wildly energetic. Their music was dynamic, unpredictable, and at times downright eccentric, yet their technical brilliance was undeniable.

Formed in the Netherlands in 1969 by guitarist Jan Akkerman and keyboardist/flautist Thijs van Leer, Focus stood apart from their British and American counterparts. While bands like Genesis focused on intricate, sprawling compositions, Focus balanced sheer instrumental prowess with an unmistakable sense of fun. Their ability to fuse baroque-style melodies with heavy rock riffs, yodeling, and flute solos made them one of the most unique progressive bands of their time.



They deserve far more recognition, not just for their musicianship but for their willingness to break conventions. Akkerman's guitar work was breathtaking—both fluid and fiery—while van Leer's keyboard and flute contributions gave the band a distinctive, almost medieval character. *Hocus Pocus* (1971) remains their most famous song, a jaw-dropping blend of shredding guitars, yodeling vocals, and relentless energy that sounds as exhilarating today as it did upon release. *Round Goes The Gossip* (1972) showcased their playfulness and compositional skill, while *Sylvia* (1972) was a rare moment of elegant, melodic beauty highlighting Akkerman's lyrical guitar playing. They weren't just ahead of their time;

they were in a world of their own—one where rock could be both technically brilliant and unashamedly fun.

My favorite songs of focus:

Hocus Pocus	Embedded Audio(HocusPocus.mp3)
Round Goes the Gossip	Embedded Audio(RoundGoesTheGossip.mp3)
Sylvia	Embedded Audio(Sylvia.mp3)

Thunder Statue(1992)

Thunder Statue, a pioneering Georgian band, remains one of the most overlooked gems in the progressive rock scene. Despite their exceptional musicianship and bold sound, they've never received the recognition they truly deserve outside their home country. Blending elements of hard rock, progressive, and experimental music, Thunder Statue's compositions were intricate, emotive, and filled with intensity. Their music spoke to a deep connection to both the natural world and the struggles of human existence, weaving traditional Georgian influences with global rock trends to create something both unique and compelling.

Formed in the late 1980s, Thunder Statue was part of Georgia's underground music scene during a turbulent period in the country's history. As the Soviet Union crumbled and the political

landscape shifted, the band captured the sense of uncertainty and transformation in their music. Their ability to blend folk-inspired melodies with progressive rock's ambitious structures made them stand out among their contemporaries. Yet, despite their powerful sound and originality, they never quite broke through, neither in international recognition nor even in the country. Thunder Statue deserves more attention for their fearless approach to music. They combined traditional Georgian rhythms with complex guitar work, intricate drum patterns, and soaring vocals, creating a sound that was uniquely their own.

Song	Georgian Version	English Version
Friend	Embedded Audio(FriendGEO.mp3)	Embedded Audio(FriendENG.mp3)
Dampness in the Head	Embedded Audio(DampnessInTheHeadGEO.mp3)	Embedded Audio(DampnessInTheHeaENG.mp3)
Star	Embedded Audio(StarGEO.mp3)	Embedded Audio(StarENG.mp3)

Author: Nino Loladze (nloladze@aat.ge)

Form

Send your favorite forgotten rock bands, which, in your opinion, deserve more recognition

Do you have a forgotten rock band that deservesfar more recognition then what they have? If yes, please fill the following form! Your input is valuable to me and this website could even become a sharing platform via this form.

Datasheet of Rock Band

Name

Your opinion, your thoughts about this band

Rating

How forgotten do you think this band is in General?

1 - Not much, but still forgotten 2 3 4 5 - Really forgotten, almost most forgotten

Personal info

Name

E-mail address

I'd like to subscribe to a newsletter

Send

Submit Reset

Submit Reset

Author: Nino Loladze (nloladze@aat.ge)